

Galileo Galilei

The “father of MODERN science”

Galileo was an astronomer, physicist, mathematician, and inventor. He is considered to be one of the most famous scientists of all time.

From medicine to math

Galileo Galilei was born in 1564 near Pisa, Italy. He *studied medicine* at the University of Pisa, but changed his mind and switched to **mathematics**, and, in 1589, he became a professor of mathematics. In 1609, Galileo heard about something called a **TELESCOPE** that had been invented in Holland.



I spy with my little eye

Amazingly, even though Galileo had never seen a telescope, he **BUILT HIS OWN VERSION** that was much better than the original. Using his new telescope, he discovered mountains and valleys on the surface of the Moon, **sunspots**, and the moons of Jupiter. His discoveries made him a *celebrity*.

Galileo originally sold his telescope as a way for towns to spot approaching enemy ships.

He couldn't have done it without...



The great **ARCHIMEDES** (c.287–212 BCE) was one of the first people to suggest that the **EARTH** **ORBITS** THE **SUN**.



PTOLEMY (90–168 CE) created **ASTRONOMICAL TABLES** that allowed people to calculate the location of the planets.

By the way... the moons of Jupiter are known as the Galilean moons and the first spacecraft to orbit Jupiter was named after me, too.